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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM
MGU-UGP (Honours)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours) Special Examinations,
July 2026 (for 2024 Admission Regular Examinations, October 2025)
THIRD SEMESTER
Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCLIH200 - VICTORIAN VISTAS AND IMPERIAL IMAGININGS : MAKERS OF ENGLISH LITERATURE
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration:2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Scheme of Valuation

Part A - MCQ

Answer all questions Each question carries1mark

1. (c) Lexington & Concord [K]/[CO1]
2. (c) Louis XVI [K]/[CO1]
3. (b) Wordsworth And Coleridge [K]/[CO2]
4. (c) Rational ideas can fail [U]/[CO2]
5. (b) A time of change and contradictions [U]/[CO3]
6. (a) Kensington Palace [K]/[CO3]
7. (c) Liberal Education [K]/[CO4]
8. (c) Lewis Caroll [K]/[CO4]
9. (a) Wessex [K]/[CO4]
10. (a) Gerard manly Hopkins [K]/[CO4]

[1x10 = 10]

Part B - SHORT ANSWER

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

11. In 1769, Richard Arkwright developed the Water Frame-a water-powered machine-produced stronger threads-increased speed- reduced manual power-required large mills [K]/[CO1]

12. Hellenism- rooted in the cultural ideals of ancient Greece-embodied a worldview centered on human experience, aesthetic harmony, and philosophical inquiry -mythology, art, philosophy, and ideals of beauty and freedom. Classical imitation-imitates the rules, style, and form of Greek and Roman literature-emphasises reason, order, balance, and discipline. [U][CO1]

13. Harold embodies the Byronic hero- a figure of restless alienation-dark charm, and moral ambiguity.-explores the restless quest for meaning in a corrupt world- Don Juan-satire, reimagining the legendary seducer as a naive youth-unfinished epic blends humour, social critique, and narrative innovation.-Ottava Rima - conversational tone [U]/[CO2]

14. Thomas De Quincey's Confessions of an English Opium-Eater-introduced psychological introspection-hallucinatory narrative - exploration of consciousness, memory, and dream anticipates modernist themes-romantic explorations of the self's depths. [U]/[CO2]

15 The Reform Acts of 1832, 1867 and 1884–85 marked watershed moments in the development of Britain's parliamentary democracy- progressively broadened the electorate-

ddressed long-standing imbalances in representation-laid the groundwork for modern democratic principles in the United Kingdom. [An]/[CO3]

16. The Crimean War- began in October 1853-a pivotal conflict-fought on the Crimean Peninsula, the war pitted Russia against an alliance of Britain, France, the Ottoman Empire, and later, Sardinia-Piedmont-originated from a mix of geopolitical ambitions and religious disputes—Russia's claim to protect Orthodox Christians within the weakening Ottoman Empire and its rivalry with France over influence in the holy places of Palestine.-Disease and inadequate medical care- deaths-Florence Nightingale, who transformed battlefield nursing and hospital hygiene, and Mary Seacole- a nurse established a care facility near the frontlines-Both contributed to the foundation of modern nursing -shifted perceptions of women's roles in wartime service. [U][CO3]

17. Silver fork novels -focusing on the lives, manners and fashions of the upper classes-elegant world of aristocratic society- detailing the social rituals, luxurious lifestyles and romantic intrigues of the elite. -idealised high society- Bulwer- Lytton's Pelham-Disraeli's Vivien Grey-Thackeray's Vanity Fair [U][CO4]

18. Best known for her deeply emotional and intellectual poetry- explores love, spirituality, feminism and social justice- used her poetry as a tool for social reform- uncommon for women writers of her time- boldly addressed issues such as child labour, slavery and oppression in her works. [U]/[CO4]

19 Victorian age-the conflict between science and religion-challenged traditional religious beliefs and the authority of the Church-Victorian writers-gave expression to this conflict and its consequences. Some remained loyal to traditional faith, condemning the 'new-fangled opinions' brought by science-others fully embraced scientific thought-many sought to strike a balance between these two opposing forces-expressed a deep sense of spiritual doubt-portraying the era's internal struggle to balance reason with belief. [U]/[CO4]

[5x6 = 30]

Part C - ESSAY

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 15 marks

20. The 18th-century Enlightenment-profound effect on agriculture-Wealthy landowner Charles Townshend and Thomas Coke of Holkham- applied scientific principles to farming-established experimental farms-agricultural societies- spread innovative techniques across Britain- Mechanization and Technological Innovation -The Enclosure Acts- Soil Enrichment and Increased Yields- Productivity and Population Growth - Social Costs and Lasting Impact [U]/[CO1]

21. Coleridge-Biographia Literaria- distinguishes between primary imagination (a basic human cognitive power)- and secondary imagination (the transformative power of the poet)-contrasting both with mere fancy (mechanical image association)- central to Romantic literary theory- introduced German idealist philosophy- ideas from Kant and Schelling. -emphasising psychological realism and poetic intuition. [U]/[CO2]

22.. The Slavery Abolition Act of 1833 -end of slavery - freedom enslaved people- Caribbean and South Africa, with some impact in Canada and other British territories.-famous figures like William Wilberforce, Thomas Clarkson, and Granville Sharp- Quakers and Evangelical

Christians-Economic changes also played a role-Slavery Abolition Act introduced a system called apprenticeship- limited their freedom- the Act helped formalize its role as a refuge for people escaping slavery in the United States-the Slavery Abolition Act- ended a brutal system and shifted Britain's moral position in the world- reflected the complicated ways -reform-progressive and conservative. [U]/[CO3]

23. Elizabeth Gaskell -gave voice to the working class, women and provincial life- combined storytelling with social reform- bridging the gap between sentimental fiction and serious social critique-the Brontë sisters -expanded the scope and depth of the Victorian novel-brought forth stories that were emotionally intense, psychologically rich and often radical in their portrayal of female experience- Charlotte's moral strength-Emily's poetic wildness-Anne's quiet realism-works challenged the boundaries of genre and gender - challenged contemporary expectations of women's roles in literature and society-laid the groundwork for modern feminist and psychological fiction-George Eliot-pioneer of realist fiction - deeply empathetic characters- philosophical insights -richly layered narratives influenced the development of the modern psychological novel. [An]/[CO4]

[15x2 = 30]